# Financial Analyst

MID-LEVEL ROLE PROFILE | Financial Planning, Analysis & Reporting

## Position overview

Analyzes financial and operational performance to support budgeting, forecasting, management reporting, and business decisions. Converts financial data into accurate analysis and clear recommendations for stakeholders.

## Experience and education

- Typically 3–5 years in financial analysis, FP&A;, management reporting, accounting, audit, or a related finance role, including experience preparing forecasts, analyzing variances, and working with financial statements.
- Bachelor’s degree in Finance, Accounting, Economics, Commerce, Business, or a related field. CA, CMA, ACCA, CFA, MBA, or other relevant qualifications may be advantageous depending on the role and employer.

## Required skills

- Strong Excel skills, including pivot tables, lookup functions, SUMIFS, financial models, data checks, and scenario analysis.
- Understanding of income statements, balance sheets, cash-flow statements, accruals, working capital, and core accounting principles.
- Budgeting, rolling forecasts, variance analysis, trend analysis, sensitivity analysis, and business-case evaluation.
- Ability to build and maintain financial models with transparent assumptions, formulas, controls, and documentation.
- Experience with ERP/finance systems and reporting tools; Power BI, Tableau, SQL, or similar tools are useful for data analysis and visualization.
- Clear presentation and communication skills: explain drivers, risks, assumptions, and recommendations to non-finance stakeholders.
- High attention to detail, analytical judgment, prioritization, and discretion with confidential financial information.

## Key responsibilities

- Prepare monthly management reports, dashboards, budgets, and periodic forecasts.
- Analyze actuals against budget, forecast, and prior periods; identify key drivers and explain material variances.
- Partner with business teams to understand performance, validate assumptions, and develop actionable recommendations.
- Build financial models for scenarios, pricing, investments, cost optimization, or new initiatives as required.
- Support month-end reporting and reconciliation activities in partnership with accounting teams.
- Improve reporting processes, data quality, and automation while maintaining appropriate controls.
- Present findings and risks clearly, ensuring calculations and source data are traceable.

## Preferred qualifications

- Experience in FP&A;, business partnering, commercial finance, cost analysis, or a relevant industry.
- Exposure to Power BI/Tableau, SQL, financial planning software, or ERP tools such as SAP or Oracle.
- Progress toward a relevant professional finance qualification.

## What success looks like

- Reports and forecasts are accurate, timely, and supported by traceable assumptions.
- Variance explanations identify the underlying business drivers rather than only reporting numbers.
- Stakeholders use the analysis to make better-informed spending, planning, and performance decisions.

Role scope varies across FP&A;, commercial finance, accounting, and investment analysis. Confirm the employer’s reporting standards, systems, and qualification requirements before publishing a vacancy.